2-3 Integrations

Identify core workflows, functionality and integrations necessary for a “lovable” product.

Identifying Integrations Necessary for a Lovable Product

> **TLDR:** Choose Katana as the first integration for Method’s hybrid inventory prototype. It offers the best combination of modern MWD fit, robust inventory features, extensible integration, and a delightful user experience—exactly what’s needed to deliver a "lovable" hybrid experience.

As we move forward with the Hybrid prototype as our chosen direction, the next critical step is to identify which **third-party inventory system** should serve as our initial integration. This integration will complement Method’s native functionality by supporting companies that require more than what Method offers out of the box—whether that means deeper functionality in areas we already support or more advanced inventory workflows that fall outside our MLP scope. Choosing the right integration is essential to delivering a **lovable hybrid experience** that gives customers the flexibility to scale with them over time.

We are currently evaluating **SOS Inventory** and **Katana** as leading candidates for our first integration. To guide this decision, we’ve established a focused set of criteria:

- **MWD Alignment** – How well the platform supports workflows for our core verticals
- **Integration Synergy** – API maturity, setup simplicity, and ability to sync key objects cleanly
- **Pricing Structure** – Total cost of ownership for our customers, including per-seat costs and feature tiers
- **Future Proofing & Scalability** – Capacity to grow with customers as their operations evolve
- **Usability & Learning Curve** – Ease of adoption for users
- **Lovable Product Factor** – How polished, intuitive, and delightful the experience is for end users
- **Integration Demand** - How often has our customers asked for this integration

The goal is to choose a partner that empowers Method to deliver a truly **lovable inventory experience**—one that feels native, scales with our users, and reinforces Method as the central connected hub for inventory.

SOS Inventory vs. Katana: Side-by-Side Comparison

	Criteria	SOS Inventory	Katana	Recommendation
1	**MWD Alignment**	**Summary:** Great for MWD companies that need affordable, full-spectrum inventory and order management—especially if they rely on QuickBooks. • Well-suited for tracking everything from raw materials to sales orders • Broad range of operational workflows—especially for distributors and wholesalers • Includes all necessary inventory management features needed to manage and fulfill inventory:	**Summary:** Best for modern manufacturers and omnichannel MWD businesses that need real-time MRP and seamless e-commerce and accounting integrations. • Excellent production features, like production status tracking • Designed for MTO (make to order) and MTS (make to stock) workflows • Ideal for omnichannel wholesalers and manufacturers scaling their operations. • Includes all necessary inventory management features needed to manage and fulfill inventory:	✅ Katana
2	**Integration Synergy**	• Deep 2-way QuickBooks Online sync • Open API available for integration (including via Zapier) • Less extensive integration library compared to Katana • REST API for deeper integration	• Native integrations with QBO, Xero etc. • Integrations with Zapier and an open API • Extensive integration library including native integrations with Hubspot and Salesforce • Custom integration possible with Katana's API (Professional plan required)	✅ Katana
3	**Pricing Structu**	**Summary:** SOS is relatively affordable for SMBs and offers a	**Summary:** While Katana's per-month cost is higher, it could be	Depends on

	re	lower up-front cost for teams that don't mind per-user licensing pricing. • Tiers range from $65/month (Companion), $130/month (Plus), and $180/month (Pro) • Scales with $25/user beyond plan limits • Tiers differ by feature set: eg Companion allows 1 warehouse, and Plus/Pro unlimited locations • Affordable for small teams; TCO rises with headcount	cost-effective for larger teams due to unlimited users. • Tiers range (annual pricing) from $179/month (Starter), $359/month (Standard), $799/month (Professional), and $1,799/month (Professional Plus) • Flat pricing per plan with unlimited users • Tiers differ by feature set: eg 1, 3, 10 and unlimited # of warehouses respectfully for the above tiers • More expensive upfront but scales better with headcount	team size: Analysis
4	**Future Proofing & Scalability**	**Summary**: SOS is future-proof for small-to-mid MWD businesses but may not meet the needs of large enterprises in the long term. • Mature platform, reliable for SMBs • Product development is steady but slow • Limited innovation or roadmap evolution	**Summary**: Katana offers flexibility, scalability, and an active roadmap, making it a strong future-proof choice for growing MWD businesses, provided the cost is justifiable. • Actively evolving with frequent feature updates and responsive to user feedback • Roadmap aligned to growing MWD complexity • Scales with transaction volume and users	✅ Katana
5	**Usability & Learning Curve**	**Summary**: SOS offers deep capabilities but requires more learning upfront for effective use. • Functional UI, steeper learning curve • Non-technical users may find the interface and setup process overwhelming	**Summary**: Katana has a low learning curve for an MRP system, enabling MWD teams to adopt it with minimal friction. • Clean, modern UI; highly intuitive • New users can get up and running fast	✅ Katana

		• Extensive documentation and support • Initial setup may require professional assistance	• Katana Academy and in-app onboarding • Low learning curve for MRP system	
6	**"Lovable" Product Factor**	**Summary**: Wins trust through robust capabilities, ROI, and reliability, though it may not excite with design. • Reliable and consistent experience • Builds trust over time • Less "delight," more functional/stable • Solid user ratings (~4.0/5 on G2, ~4.3/5 on Capterra) • Strong ROI and value for money	**Summary**: Extremely delightful experience among users. • High user satisfaction scores • Strong reputation with 4.5+ star reviews and industry recognition (e.g. Capterra Top 20 MRP list) • Visual, interactive workflows (e.g. live order status) • Fast feedback loop enhances product love • Highly praised support and responsiveness	✅ Katana
7	**Integration Demand**	25 accounts (Value: $38,400) have requested direct integration with SOS Inventory	4 accounts (Value: $28,200) have requested direct integration with Katana	✅ SOS

ChatGPT Original Prompt/Analysis

Partner Feedback:

Paulette Dreher

Inventory Co-Creation Intro Call:

> **John Miranda:** “I guess uh inventory management uh product like SOS, Katana or or your contacts prefer using or um like if you understand my question.”
>
> **Paulette Dreher:** “They don't care. They really listen to us. Okay. So, um I happen to like Katana better. Uh I SOS is great. it. But to me, it has like an older feel. Just visually, it has an older feel. And um I just think for the, you know, people your age and younger that are getting into this, they want something slick on the phone. They they they're not going to like it. Okay? And um that's probably unfair because we are partners with SOS and we do have clients there. But I I if I can I recommend uh Katana”

> **John Miranda:** “what would success look like for an inventory management solution here at Method?”
>
> **Paulette Dreher:** “get me an integration with Katana, you know, pick one”
>
> **Paulette Dreher:** “And basically the integration um in its simplistic form would be let me be able to see um quantity on hand um integrate uh sales orders.”

Prototype Testing Live Demo Feedback:

> **John Miranda:** “we're exploring SOS and katana as com as possible solutions”
>
> **Paulette Dreher:** “In my opinion, they're the best. and I think I expressed that I happen to Katana better. Visually, it looks better, but SOS is been around for a long time and, We have clients on both, so it's just a personal preference, but I think that's smart that you're looking at both.”

Jason Masina

Waiting for Feedback

Synthesis:

Both SOS Inventory and Katana are capable systems, but they excel in different ways. If Method CRM's priority is maximum adoption among small-to-medium MWD businesses with tight budgets, SOS Inventory is the pragmatic choice. However, if optimizing for long-term product love, scalability, and MWD alignment, Katana is the more future-proof and lovable partner—and a better match for our hybrid prototype.

Strategic Decision:

Based on the side-by-side analysis and partner feedback, **Katana emerges as the stronger long-term strategic partner** for our hybrid prototype—especially since the goal is to deliver a *lovable, scalable, and robust* inventory experience for MWD businesses.

While SOS currently has higher direct integration demand from existing accounts and wins on cost for smaller teams, that advantage fades quickly—and cost alone doesn't define a truly lovable experience. This is outweighed by:

- Katana's stronger alignment with MWD workflows
- Robust and extensive inventory management features
- Superior integration flexibility, UI/UX, and roadmap
- Partner preference especially for future-proofing and delight

The incremental short-term demand for SOS does not justify long-term trade-offs in usability, scalability, and product love. However it does make it a compelling candidate for a potential second integration in the future.